

Realme Narzo 70 Pro

Innovative and feature-rich, but lacks polish

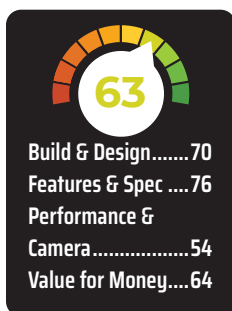
The Realme Narzo series has quite a great reputation in the mid-range smartphone market. Especially after last year, Realme made a genuine effort to improve the series' camera tuning and design. Now, the company is back with a new Narzo series phone for the year 2024. Enter the Realme Narzo 70 Pro, a sub-₹30,000 that has a lot to offer; at least on paper. The Realme Narzo 70 Pro comes packing a 2,000 nit AMOLED display, a flagship-grade Sony IMX890 primary camera, and a ton of compelling features such as Air Gestures, Rainwater Smart Touch, a VC cooling system, Flash Capsule, and more.

Moreover, the company has also addressed the bloatware issue that plagued us in the Realme 12 Pro series by reducing the number of preinstalled third-party apps by 65 per cent. However, there's a lot of solid competition in the market from the likes of the Nothing Phone (2a) and the iQOO Z9. Will the Realme Narzo 70 Pro manage to stand out in this cutthroat landscape? Let's find out.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Realme Narzo 70 Pro features a solid, premium design language. Granted, there's no vegan leather back like its predecessor, but the matte plus glossy rear panel looks striking. The Glass Green colour variant I got for review particularly looks super premium – it is an understated yet elegant colour. Realme calls this the Horizon Glass design. There are some misses though.

The glossy part of the back panel attracts a lot of fingerprints and



smudges over time. Additionally, the glossy metallic frame also looks rather rough with use; once again acting as a fingerprint magnet.

The large circular camera module has become a staple with Realme phones now; I like it, it gives the phone character. However,

it doesn't look nearly as elegant as the Realme number series phones. Still, a great look for the price point.

The screen houses an in-display fingerprint scanner that worked flawlessly in my testing. The phone also has dual stereo speakers with Dolby Atmos support, and these are one of the best-sounding stereo speakers on a phone at this price. The bezels on the display are quite thick though; especially the chin bezel, so I hope Realme can trim this down in the next iteration.

DISPLAY

The Realme Narzo 70 Pro has quite a stellar display. It's a 6.67-inch AMOLED panel with Full HD+ resolution and 120

Hz refresh rate. The display supports 16.7 million colours and 100 per cent of the DCI-P3 colour gamut. The AMOLED display has deep blacks and vibrant colours. They're close to accurate and content looks great on this screen.

A quick look through DevCheck confirmed that the display supports HDR10+, however, it did not work on the Netflix app. HDR worked perfectly on YouTube, so I hope Realme brings support to Netflix as soon as possible too. The display is also quite bright. It has a rated local peak brightness of 2,000 nits and in my testing, I got a reading of 1378 nits under bright sunlight.

PERFORMANCE

Powered by the MediaTek Dimensity 7050 SoC, the Realme Narzo 70 Pro is not the fastest phone on the block. In fact, even the iQOO Z9, which is priced under ₹20K has a faster Dimensity 7200 processor. The processor is the same as the one on its predecessor, which is disappointing. However, the phone does have faster UFS 3.1 storage which beats the read and write speed numbers of the Nothing Phone (2a) and iQOO Z9.

As for raw performance, the Realme Narzo 70 Pro scored 6,07,063 in AnTuTu v10; not the best score but decent enough. You can see the pattern repeat in GeekBench as well where it scored lower than its competitors. However, it did redeem itself in PCMark Work with a score of more than 12K. So, it is a capable phone for day-to-day tasks such as using social media, light photo editing, using Excel Sheets, and more.

However, the GPU scores are much lower than competing products in both 3D Mark and GFXBench as you can see in the graphs below. So, if you're an ardent gamer, this is not the best phone for your needs at this price. You can only play games on Low to Medium graphics without too much lag disrupting your experience. There's a VC cooling chamber that helps control heat, but the phone really isn't meant for intensive gameplay.

As for UI, FINALLY, Realme has listened to its consumers and the